CARGOLANE · USER MANUAL

Finance

Invoicing, receipts and receivables. Yours alone, and deliberately so.

> Read **Getting started** first.

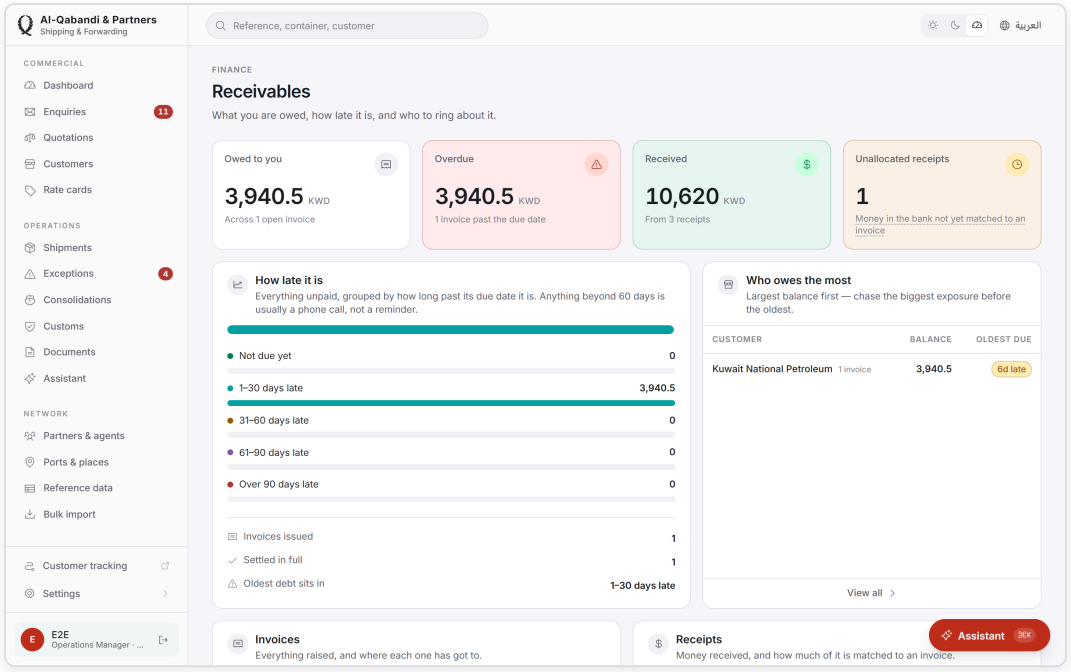
What you hold, and why nobody else does

YOURS ALONE	ALSO YOURS
Approve an invoice	Record duty paid on a customs declaration
Issue an invoice	Capture a supplier's bill and match it
Void an invoice	Run a set-off with an agent
Raise a credit note	Split a consolidation's master cost across its houses
Record a receipt	Let a customer trade past their credit limit
Approve a supplier's bill for payment, and **pay** it	Read every shipment
Post the period to the accounting package	Read and export the dashboards and the margin report

Only Finance may issue, void or credit. An operations manager who could issue invoices is the classic separation-of-duties failure, and it is the first one an auditor asks about. It is enforced by the system, not by an instruction — which is the answer you can give when asked. The same line runs through money out: a coordinator or an operations manager can capture what an agent billed, and only you can approve it for payment or pay it.

You **cannot** book or update shipments, change rate cards, or send quotations. If an invoice is wrong because the job is wrong, the job gets fixed by operations and the invoice gets credited by you. Neither of you fixes the other's record.

The receivables screen



Receivables: owed, overdue, received, and who owes the most.

Finance → Overview. The subtitle is the whole job: *what you are owed, how late it is, and who to ring about it.*

	WHAT IT MEANS
Owed to you	Across every open invoice
Overdue	Past the due date
Received	What has come in
Unallocated receipts	**Money in the bank not yet matched to an invoice**

Unallocated receipts are the one to clear first

The screen warns about them explicitly, and the reason is worth stating: *until a receipt is matched, the customer still shows as owing money they have already paid.*

Every consequence of that is bad. You chase a customer who has paid. Their credit limit blocks a booking they are entitled to. Your ageing report overstates the debt and your management makes decisions on it.

Clear them daily. It is ten minutes and it is the highest-value ten minutes in this chapter.

Ageing

Everything unpaid, grouped by how late it is: not due yet, 1–30, 31–60, 61–90, over 90. The screen offers a piece of judgement with it — *anything beyond 60 days is usually a phone call, not a reminder* — and it is right.

Who owes the most

Largest balance first, not oldest. **Chase the biggest exposure before the oldest debt.** A four-month-old invoice for a small amount is an irritation; a six-week-old invoice for a large one is a risk.

Use the ageing view to decide *how* to chase and this view to decide *whom*.

Earned, not yet billed

Above the ageing, a panel counts the shipments carrying revenue that has never reached an invoice — how many lines, how much, and how old the oldest is. An unbilled charge line never ages, never appears in the ageing and is never chased, which is why it gets its own space.

Draft invoice against a row raises a draft for that shipment with its unbilled revenue lines on it, ready to approve and issue. A shipment whose lines are in more than one currency is flagged *Mixed currencies — bill separately*.

Invoicing

The states, and what each one commits

STATE	WHAT IT MEANS	REVERSIBLE?
Draft	Being built. No number yet. Charges can be added and changed.	Yes
Approved	Reviewed and ready. Still no number, still editable.	Yes — back to draft
Issued	**It takes the next number in the branch's series.**	**No**
Part paid / **Paid**	Receipts matched against it	—
Void	Cancelled. The number stays used.	No
Credited	A credit note replaces it	No

Issuing cannot be undone. The system says so before you do it. An issued invoice can only be corrected by a credit note — and that is the point, because an invoice that can be silently edited after the customer has it is not a document either of you can rely on.

Voiding keeps the number. The series has no gap. An invoice series with a missing number is a question at every audit, and the answer *"we deleted it"* is never a good one.

Building it

Add charges while it is a draft. Each line carries:

- **Description** — what the customer will actually read
- **Charge type** — groups the line on the printed invoice
- **Quantity, unit price**
- **Taxable** — tax is added at this invoice's rate where the line is taxable

Totals recalculate from the lines. There is no total you type over.

Tax treatment

Set per invoice: **standard rate**, **zero rated**, **exempt**, **out of scope**, **reverse charge**.

This is not decoration — it is what makes an invoice raised by your UAE entity and one raised by your Kuwait entity both correct at the same time. Set it from the entity and the transaction, not from habit.

Document language

Each invoice carries its own language, English or Arabic. Set it to what the customer wants to receive, not to what you are reading the screen in.

Currency

Every charge line stores **its own exchange rate and the moment it was taken**. A job quoted in dollars and invoiced in dinars reconciles months later because the rate is recorded rather than recalculated.

Amounts round per currency at the line. KWD carries three decimal places and the system knows it. You do not need to correct dinar amounts for rounding, and you should not try.

Receipts

Finance → Payments. What came in, and how much of each has been matched.

Record: the date received, the customer, their reference, the method — bank transfer, cheque, cash, card or offset — and the amount.

Then allocate it. A receipt can be matched across several invoices, and part of a receipt can sit unallocated if the customer has overpaid or paid on account. The register shows what is matched and what is not, and the overview screen counts the unmatched ones at the top.

Recorded by is captured automatically. So is the time. Neither can be changed afterwards.

Duty

You can record duty paid on a customs declaration. So can the customs broker and the operations manager; a coordinator cannot.

The declaration shows the duty assessed. Recording payment moves the declaration forward toward release, and it is usually what somebody is waiting on — a container sitting for a payment nobody recorded is demurrage accruing on your own delay.

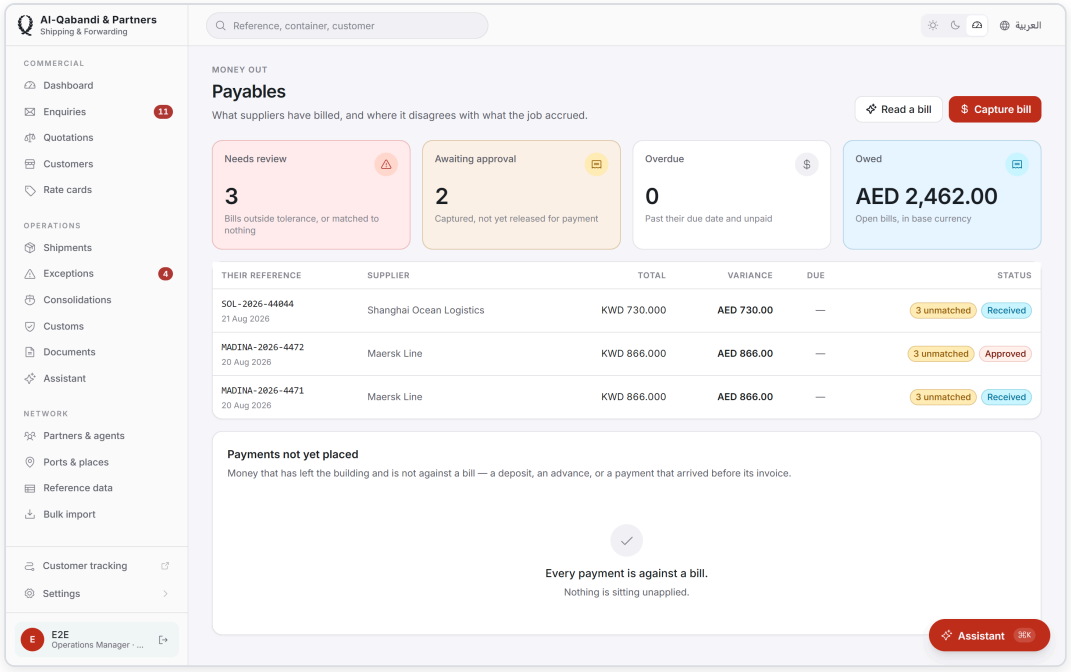
Charges that appear without anyone entering them

Free-time clocks write their own charge lines. Demurrage, detention and storage accrue against the carrier's free days and post automatically, against the right counterparty at the right per-diem rate.

Two consequences for you:

1. **Do not enter these by hand.** You will duplicate them.
2. **They arrive after delivery.** A job closed the day it was delivered may close before its last accrued charge lands. This is why the operations manager is told to check job costs before closing, and it is worth being the person who reminds them.

Payables



Payables: what suppliers have billed, where it disagrees with the job, and the bills a scan or an email brought in.

Finance → Payables. What suppliers have billed, and where it disagrees with what the job accrued. The subtitle is the job, and the four counters at the top are the order to work in:

	WHAT IT MEANS
Needs review	Bills outside tolerance, or matched to nothing. **Start here.**
Awaiting approval	Captured, not yet released for payment
Overdue	Past their due date and unpaid
Owed	Open bills, in base currency

Capture, match, approve, pay — and who does which

Four acts, and the split is the separation of duties a forwarder actually runs on:

ACT	WHO	WHY
Capture bill	Coordinator, operations manager, or you	The coordinator holding the file is the only person who can say which of the thirty shipments on a monthly agent invoice each line belongs to
Match each line to the job's cost line	The same	Billing more than was accrued is allowed — that is the finding
Approve for payment	**You alone**	With the variance in front of you. Approving a bill that is 15% over its accrual is a decision somebody has to own
Record payment, then **Allocate** it	**You alone**	Moving the money

Collapsing the first two with the third would mean the person who entered the bill is the person who cleared it — the segregation failure an auditor asks about immediately after invoice issuance.

Read a bill captures from a scan: upload the PDF or a photograph and the lines are read for you. It lands as *Received*, like anything typed in, and you still approve it. If the figures do not add up, nothing is written and the scan is kept on file. It needs a model key under *Settings → Integrations*.

Lines and matches

Open a bill. Each of their lines sits beside what it was matched to, with a verdict: **Agrees**, **Within tolerance**, **Billed over**, **Billed under**, **Not billed**. Tolerance comes from the charge type, or from the partner's own tolerance where one has been set on their page — whichever is more generous.

Approve is offered when everything agrees. When something does not, the bill says so — *Some lines are outside tolerance, or matched to nothing at all* — and approving means ticking **Approve anyway** and writing why the variance is acceptable. That reason is the record. **Dispute** sends it back with what is wrong; **Void** is only for a bill nothing has been paid against. Their invoice number is captured exactly as printed, and capturing the same number twice is refused.

Payments not yet placed

At the foot of the payables screen: money that has left the building and is not against a bill — a deposit, an advance, a payment that arrived before its invoice. **Allocate** each one. Part payments are the norm.

Settlements

Finance → Settlements. An agent is both a supplier and a customer — they bill you for the far end and you bill them for yours. A settlement nets both sides of the account for a period into a single figure, so one payment moves instead of two.

Before anything can be netted, the partner must be linked to the customer record they invoice you as — *Current account* on their partner page. Nothing guesses at which customer record an agent is, because a wrong guess nets a settlement against a different company.

Draft settlement — branch, agent, period, and the agreed rate where the two sides are in different currencies. One currency by agreement; a set-off is not a currency trade. The draft lists every open document in the period that no earlier settlement has claimed: your invoices and credit notes, their bills, receipts and payments either way. It shows **They owe us**, **We owe them**, the **Set off**, and the **Residual** with its direction — *They pay us*, *We pay them*, or *Square*.

Agree statement when both sides have signed it off. **Residual settled** when the balancing payment has moved. A settlement is never deleted; one that was voided stays on the list with the reason against it.

Running a set-off is yours and the operations manager's. It changes what both sides owe without any money moving, so it sits with whoever answers for the relationship rather than with either ledger.

Credit control

Each customer's page carries **Standing and exceptions**: what they owe, their credit limit, the headroom or the excess, and every override ever made for them. Amounts in a currency with no exchange rate are listed separately, and the exposure shown is a floor rather than a total.

Booking checks this. A customer on hold, or one a shipment would take past their limit, cannot be booked, and the coordinator is told so. The answer is **Record an override** — for one shipment, one invoice, or everything for that customer until a date — with a reason a reviewer can act on in a year. The limit itself is set under the customer's commercial terms and stays where it is.

You and the operations manager both hold this, and that is deliberate: a check only one of you can clear is a check that gets routed around at four in the afternoon.

Unallocated receipts feed straight into this. A customer who has paid and whose receipt sits unmatched is a customer whose booking is refused for money they do not owe.

Consolidations

A coordinator builds the master and attaches the houses; **Split** divides each master cost across them, by volume, chargeable weight, gross weight, packages, equally, or stated by hand. It writes an ordinary charge line onto every house, so invoicing and the export need to know nothing about consolidation, and **Reverse** posts the negative rather than deleting, because the lines may already sit on an issued invoice. Splitting is yours and the operations manager's — it decides twenty margins at once.

Export

Accounting exports, on the overview screen, hand a period to your accounting package as a journal — invoices, credit notes, costs and receipts, posted to the accounts mapped on each branch.

	WHAT IT DOES
Preview journal	Builds the journal for an entity and a period, and marks nothing. Run it as often as you like.
Post period	Stamps every invoice, cost and receipt it covers. A second export of the same period finds nothing.
Void	Releases everything the export claimed, with a reason kept on the record, so the period can be exported again.

Post once you are satisfied with the preview. Posting consumes the period; getting it back is a void with a reason, and *"why was this period posted twice"* is a question the reason has to answer.

The accounts come from the branch. *Settings → Branches* carries each entity's chart of accounts — receivables, payables, bank, output tax, FX variance, rounding — and each charge type carries its revenue and cost account under *Reference data*. Leave them blank until you have the codes; the export names what is missing rather than guessing.

There is no direct connector to an accounting package in this release. The journal export is the path today.

Finance → Reports is the margin report — shipments by the date they sailed, cut by branch, customer, trade lane, mode or salesperson — and **Export CSV** takes it out whole.

Your week

WHEN	WHAT
Daily	Unallocated receipts. Clear every one.
Daily	New receipts recorded and matched
Daily	Payables — *Needs review*, then *Awaiting approval*
Weekly	Overdue — the 61–90 and 90+ buckets, by phone
Weekly	Who owes the most — largest exposure first
Weekly	Earned, not yet billed — draft the invoices
Weekly	Payments not yet placed — allocate every one
On completion	Invoice the jobs operations has completed
Before closing a job	Check the free-time charges have landed and the consolidation costs are split
Monthly	Settlements — draft the set-off for each agent with a current account
Monthly	Preview the journal, then post the period; reconcile the receipt account
Monthly	Check the invoice number series has no gaps — voids should keep theirs

Four things not to do

Do not edit an issued invoice by any route. There is no route, and looking for one means the credit note is the answer.

Do not delete a receipt to correct it. Nothing is deleted here. Correct the allocation.

Do not leave money unallocated over a weekend. Everything downstream of it is wrong until you do, including how your colleagues treat that customer.

Do not close the month with unmatched receipts on the register. The ageing report is wrong by exactly that amount, and somebody will act on it.